(Union of Myanmar 2015c, p. 48). This number is probably under-reported, however, as it does not take into account families living in KIO-controlled areas, where many families have male soldiers based away for most of the year:

> Mostly, the husband will go to the frontline so usually the woman has to take care of the family. This is a big problem. The family could neither stay in the village nor run to other places. If we have to move to other place, faraway place, it costs a lot of money, so women have to do the work, have to find more money for transportation, and so on. Because women are now the breadwinners for the family, they have more responsibilities.[19]

In this way, conscription plays an important role in determining not only household but community dynamics, as the critical role played by the household in sustaining the war effort, both in terms of providing essential goods and as a unit of recruitment, helps to sustain the conflict. All Kachin families living in KIA/KIO areas are pressured to support the organization, which results in a high number of female-headed households. Being responsible for the survival of near and extended families means that women often lack the time and income to participate in public decision-making processes, as the quote above aptly captures. However, in not participating, women's ability to influence these processes is constrained. In other words, household support for the KIA/KIO results in exacerbating gender inequality.

Gender inequality, and the insecurity it produces, provides the context for women's support for the KIO/KIA. This is because the ways women experience insecurity inform their reactions to the conflict, and to the armed uprising. For example, the interviews show how the renewal of the conflict itself and the suffering imposed on the household have informed Kachin women's motivations for joining the army. The majority of soldiers raised the issue of female-headed households, seen as linked to an increase in poverty, and poverty was understood as increasing young women's susceptibility to trafficking:

> In my town youths were exploited; boys became drug addicts, girls were exploited [trafficked], and the Kachin people, don't have job opportunities. … We don't have good education in our region. We didn't have anything in our houses, because the Burmans, they just take as much as they want.[20]

However, the ways women are included in the armed uprising, whether as soldiers or as members of households, ensure women's inclusion preserves rather than upsets the very gendered insecurities they set out to challenge.